from the Indian side of the LOC. It is hard to imagine that in the absence of Pakistan's possession of nuclear weapons India would have felt so constrained not to widen the scope of the conflict.

One possible objection to this line of argument needs to be anticipated and dealt with forthrightly. Did timely American intervention prevent an escalation of the conflict? This is a seemingly plausible and attractive explanation but it falls apart under careful scrutiny. Contrary to popular belief, the last major Indian military objective, the capture of Tiger Hill, took place a good *ten hours before* Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif met with President Bill Clinton on July 4, 1999, at Blair House in Washington, D.C. Sharif made this abrupt trip to Washington, D.C., in an attempt to elicit American assistance in terminating the conflict.[56] Though U.S. intercession did no harm, it cannot be adduced as a viable explanation for India's willingness to limit the scope of the conflict.[57] In effect, India had achieved its principal war aims before U.S.-Pakistani discussions to end Pakistan's incursions had started. American intercession may well have provided Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif the means for a face-saving retreat but it was not the critical element in ending the conflict.

S. PAUL KAPUR

The roots of the Kargil operation date back to the late 1980s, when Pakistan was beginning to acquire a nuclear capacity. Benazir Bhutto recalled that the army presented her with a Kargil-like plan in 1989 and 1996. According to Bhutto, the operation was designed to oust Indian forces from Siachen Glacier in northern Kashmir.[58] The army formulated a scheme by which Pakistani and Kashmiri forces would occupy the mountain peaks overlooking the Kargil region. The logic was that "if we scrambled up high enough . . . we could force India to withdraw" by severing their supply lines to Siachen. "To dislodge us," Bhutto recalled, the Indians "would have to resort to conventional war. However, our nuclear capability [gave] the military confidence that India [could not] wage a conventional war against Pakistan." Bhutto claimed that she rejected the proposal because